

LOW ACID FOODS



Kids (under 10)

Q

When you open a jar of home-canned vegetables, what sound might you hear if it's safe?

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ANSWER

**A little 'pop' from the lid
popping up**

FUN FACT

*A popping lid means the jar sealed
tight to keep food safe!*

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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Q

Which tool helps make sure low acid foods like beans or meat get hot enough to be safe at home?

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ANSWER

A pressure canner that uses steam and pressure

FUN FACT

Pressure canners use big heat to keep your food yummy and safe!

Source: PNW 421 Use care operation of your pressure canner

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Q

If you live high on a mountain, what might you do to your pressure canner to keep your food safe?

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ANSWER

Use more pressure because water boils at a lower temperature

FUN FACT

High places need extra pressure to cook food safely!

Source: EM 9435 Preserving dried beans

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Q

What kind of food needs a pressure canner instead of boiling water to be safely canned at home?

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ANSWER

Low acid foods like vegetables, meat, and fish

FUN FACT

Low acid foods need special heat to keep germs away!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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Q

Why can't we just use boiling water to can low acid foods like green beans safely?

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ANSWER

Because boiling water isn't hot enough to kill bacteria in low acid foods

FUN FACT

Pressure canners get hotter than boiling water to keep food safe!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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**What is something fun
you see when using a
pressure canner for the
first time?**

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ANSWER

Steam comes out and the lid locks tight!

FUN FACT

Steam helps get the food inside very hot so it stays safe.

Source: PNW 421 Use care operation of your pressure canner

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If you hear a steady hissing or puffing noise from your pressure canner, what is that?

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ANSWER

Steam escaping from the vent tube

FUN FACT

That steam means the canner is working hard to keep the food safe.

Source: PNW 421 Use care operation of your pressure canner

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Which lid type tells you that your home canned jar sealed and is safe to eat?

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ANSWER

A lid that stays pressed down flat and doesn't pop up

FUN FACT

A tight lid means air can't get into the jar to spoil the food.

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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What does the dial or weighted gauge on a pressure canner do?

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ANSWER

It helps you know the right pressure for safe canning

FUN FACT

Watching the gauge helps keep your food safe when canning low acid foods!

Source: EM 9435 Preserving dried beans

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Which food is considered low acid and needs pressure canning at home?

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ANSWER

Cooked green beans

FUN FACT

Green beans need extra heat from pressure canning to be safe.

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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How do you feel when you carefully open the lid of a pressure canner after it cools?

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ANSWER

Warm steam blowing away, but safely not too hot

FUN FACT

Opening the lid slow and away from your face keeps you safe from hot steam!

Source: EM 9435 Preserving dried beans

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Why do jars need space (headspace) at the top inside a pressure canner?

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ANSWER

**So food can expand safely
when heated**

FUN FACT

*Leaving space helps jars not break
during cooking!*

Source: EM 9435 Preserving dried beans

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What color might the food be if it's been safely pressure canned and stored?

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ANSWER

Bright or close to fresh colors

FUN FACT

Good color means your canned food looks tasty and fresh!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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Q

Which smell might tell you a home canned jar has gone bad and you shouldn't eat it?

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ANSWER

A sour or rotten smell when opened

FUN FACT

Bad smells mean germs grew inside, so don't eat it!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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Q

When using a pressure canner, can you open the lid while the food is cooking inside?

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ANSWER

**No, always wait until it cools
and pressure is gone**

FUN FACT

*Opening too early can be dangerous
because of hot steam and bubbles!*

Source: EM 9435 Preserving dried beans

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Which food is NOT a low acid food that needs pressure canning?

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ANSWER

Peach slices packed in syrup

FUN FACT

Sweet fruits usually can be safely canned in boiling water, not pressure canners.

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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If your home canned jar lid lifts and wobbles when pressed, what does that mean?

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ANSWER

The jar didn't seal right and food might spoil

FUN FACT

A good sealed lid won't move when pushed in the middle!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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If you want to can your own chicken safely at home, what do you need to use?

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ANSWER

A pressure canner to make it safe

FUN FACT

Pressure canners kill bacteria so your canned chicken is safe to eat!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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Which is a sign that your pressure canner is working properly during canning?

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ANSWER

Steam is gently escaping from the vent tube

FUN FACT

Steam tells you the canner is building pressure for safety.

Source: PNW 421 Use care operation of your pressure canner

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What should you do after removing jars from a pressure canner to help them seal well?

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ANSWER

Let the jars sit on the counter and cool without tightening the lids

FUN FACT

Cooling jars slowly helps make a tight lid seal for safe storage!

Source: EM 9435 Preserving dried beans